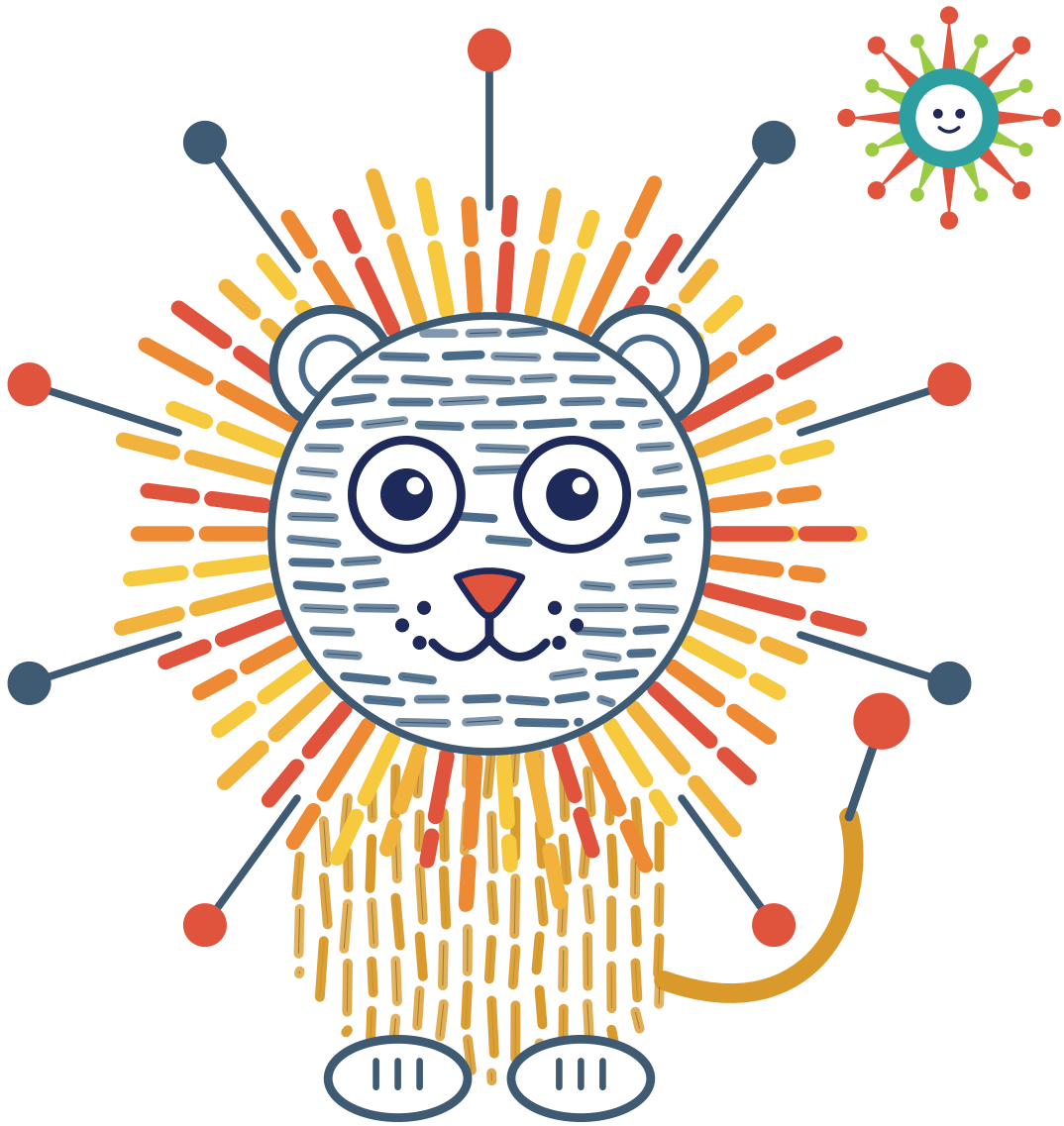
Leon’s Thinking Book

Volume 2 · Ages 6–8



Written and illustrated by **Robert de Farias**

Leon’s Thinking Book — Volume 2 (Ages 6–8)
Written and illustrated by Robert de Farias

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First edition. Independently published.

Safety: For children aged 6 and up. Use colored pencils or crayons.

This book offers playful practice for children. It is not a test, a diagnosis or a substitute for advice from a teacher or health professional.

Explorer card

Draw yourself

My name

My age

My favorite game

I promise to think, try and have fun!

Hello, grown-ups!

Leon's Thinking Book, Volume 2 is for children aged 6 to 8. The games are a step up from Volume 1: more steps, more rules to keep in mind and more puzzles to plan.

The pages offer playful practice with paying attention, holding information in mind, remembering what you see, logic, patterns, numbers, words, space, solving problems, planning and talking about feelings.

A few tips

• Most children can read the instructions alone. Stay nearby to help.
• Pages with an ear icon need you to read something aloud.
• Pages with an eye icon: look, then turn the page.
• Three stars mean a real challenge. It is fine to need help or to try twice.
• Ask "How did you work it out?" Explaining is great thinking practice.

The answers are on pages 77 to 79.

Have fun together!

How to use this book

Two stars: think it through.

Three stars: a real challenge!

Listen: a grown-up reads something aloud.

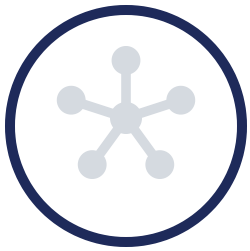
Look and remember: look, then turn the page.

Leon tries, gets it wrong and tries again. So can you!

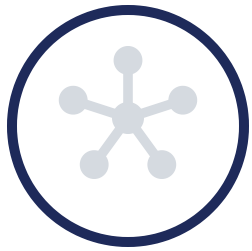
Luz lights up when you have an idea.

Mission tracker

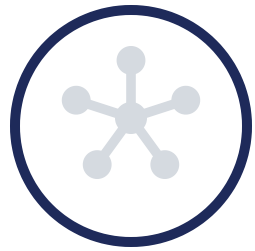
Finish a mission? Color its badge!



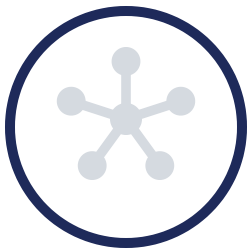
Selective Attention
page 8



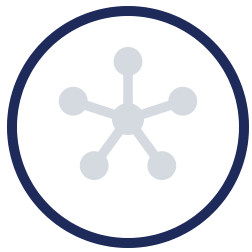
Working Memory
page 14



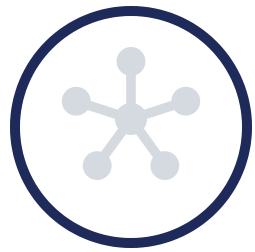
Visual Memory
page 20



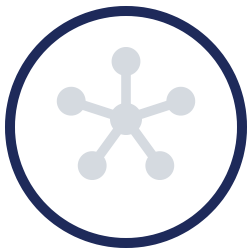
Logic
page 26



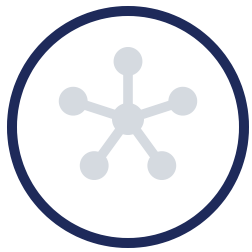
Patterns
page 33



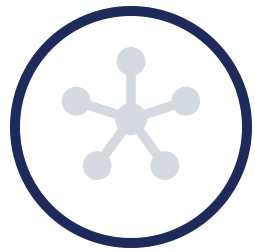
Mathematics
page 38



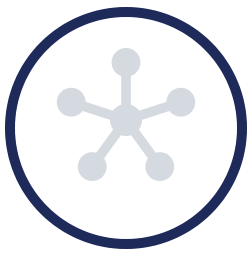
Language
page 46



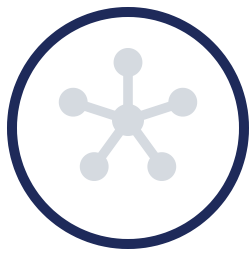
Spatial Reasoning
page 53



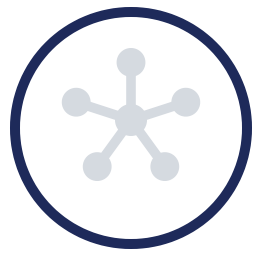
Problem Solving
page 59



Planning
page 64



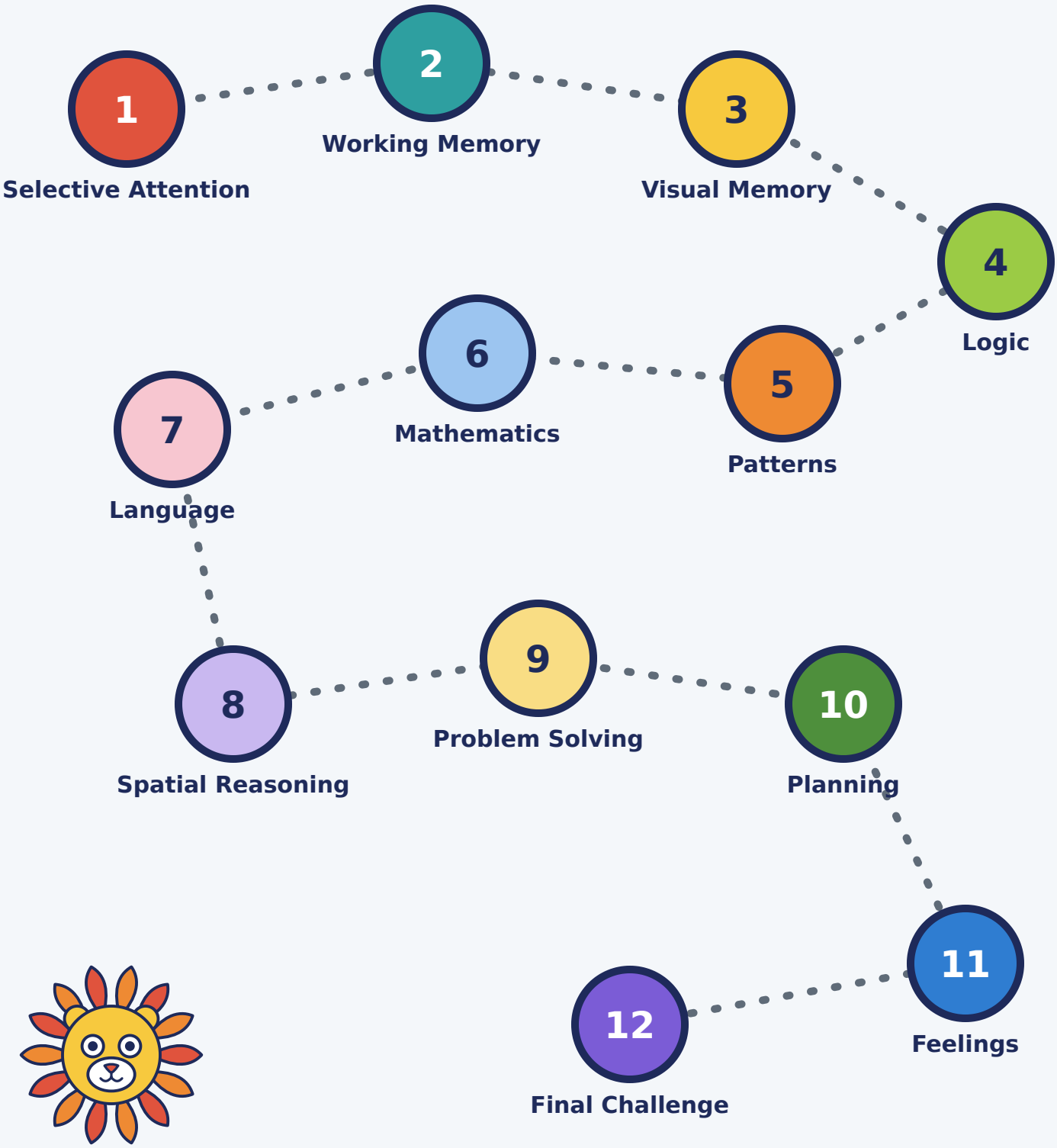
Feelings
page 69



Final Challenge
page 73

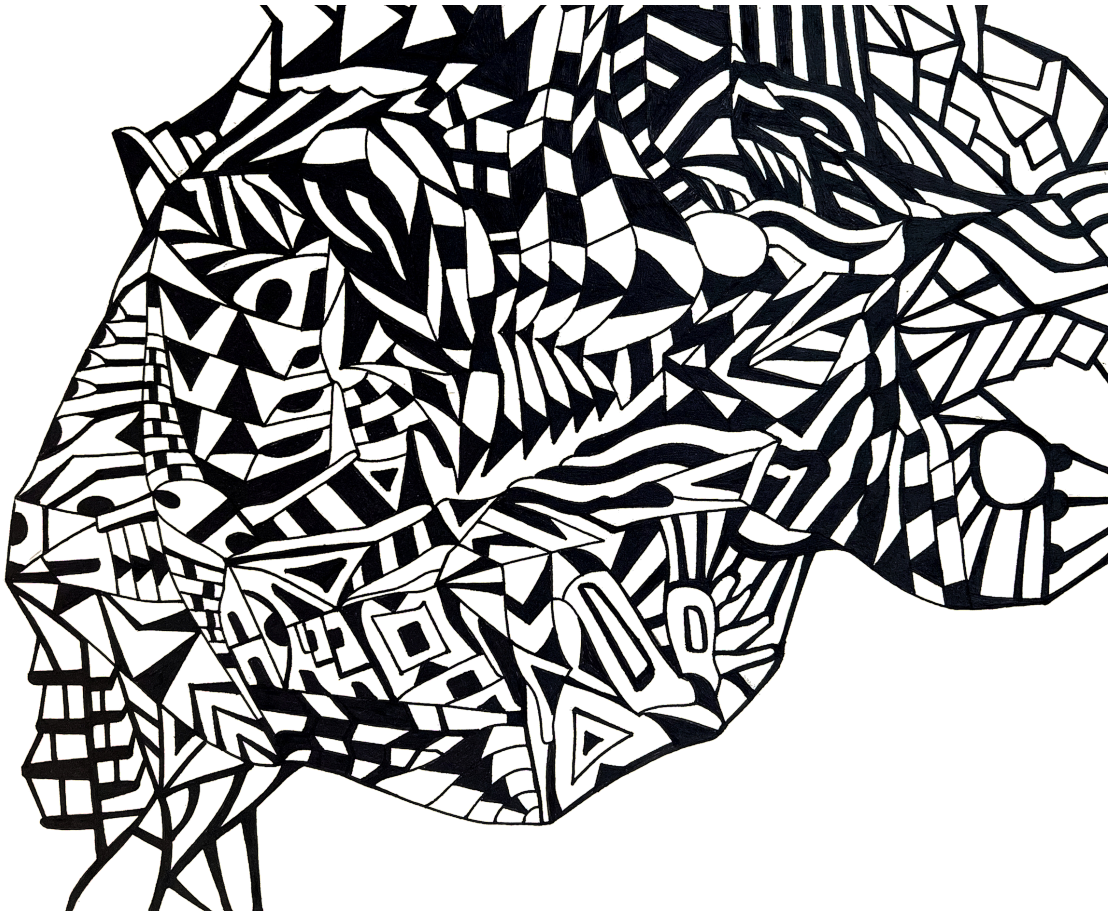
Mission map

12 missions. Are you ready?



Detail detective

Three circles come from this face. One does not. Circle it.



A

B

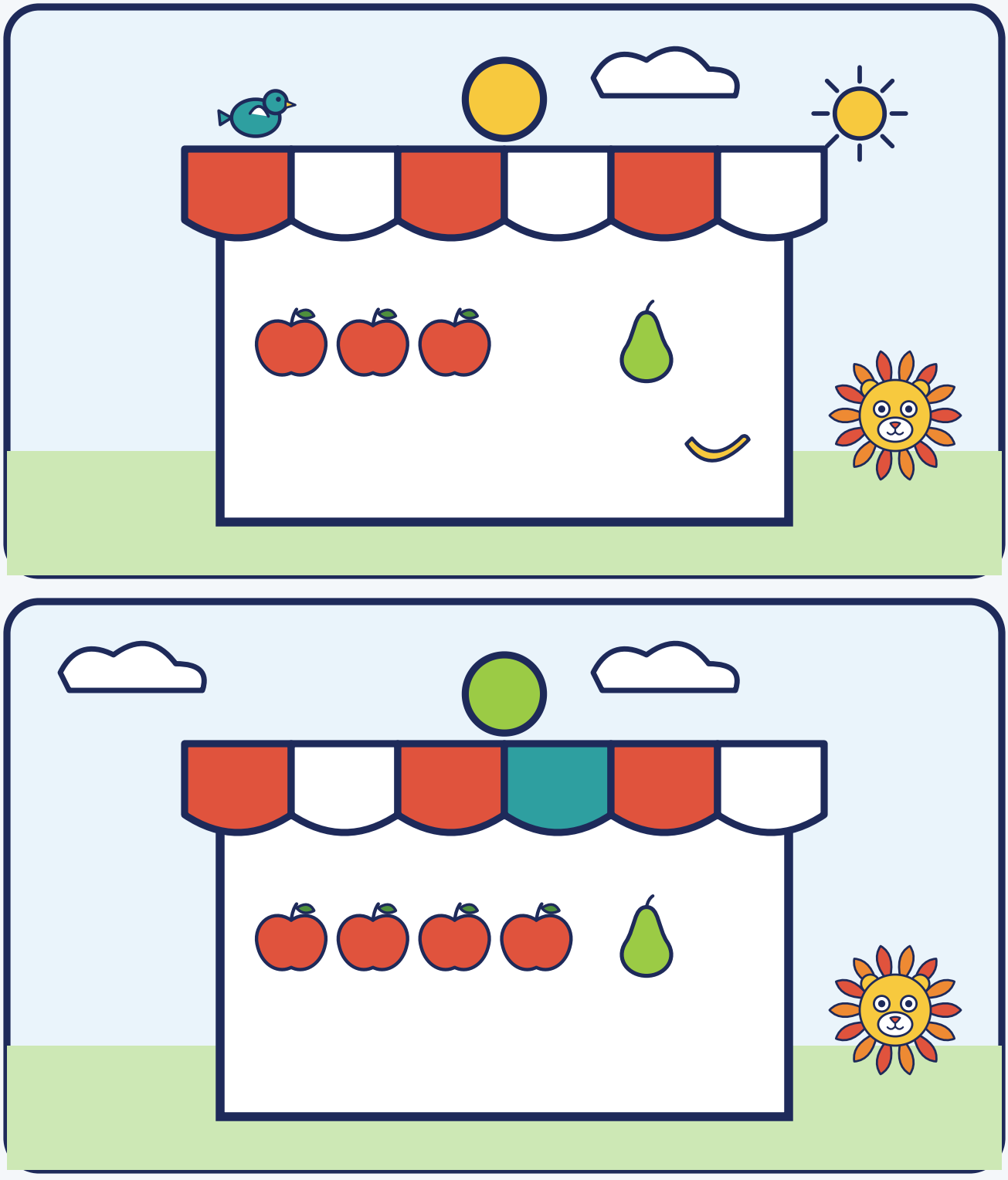
C

D

Artwork: Robert de Farias

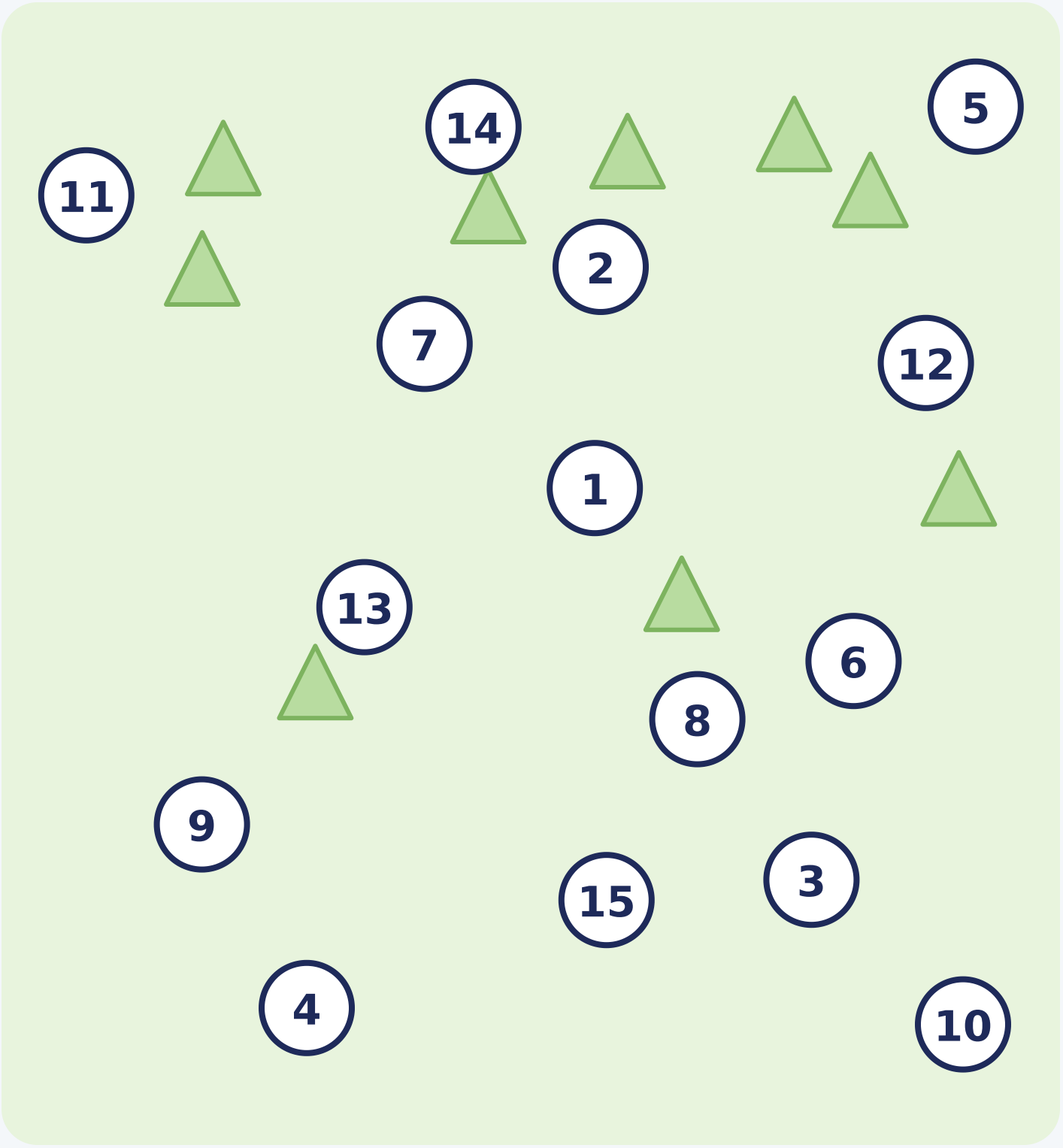
7 differences

Find 7 differences in the bottom picture. Circle them.



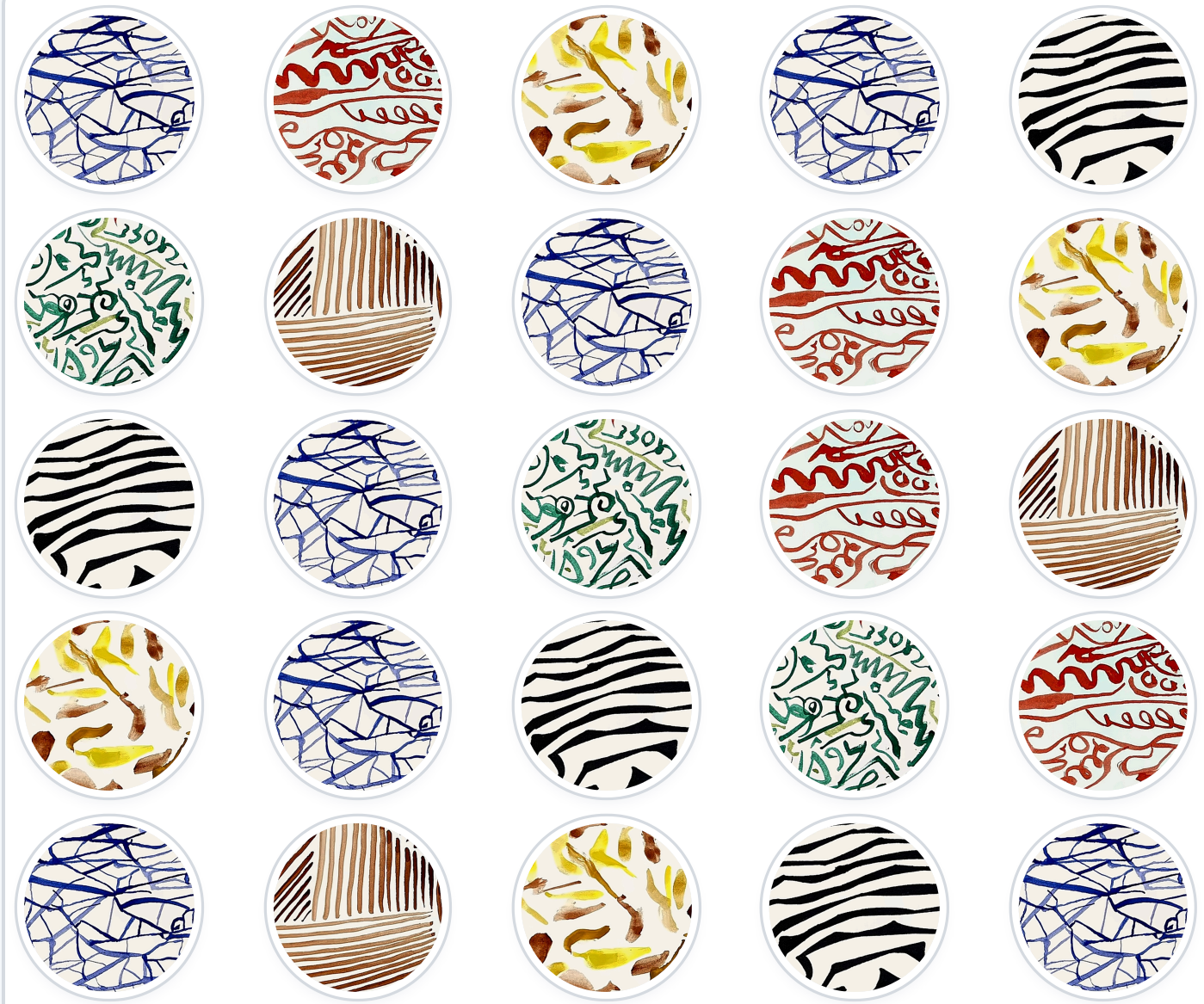
Number trail

Draw a line from 1 to 2 to 3 ... all the way to 15. Go as fast as you can, but be careful!



Only blue circles

Count only the blue circles. Write how many.



Artwork: Robert de Farias

Odd one out PRO

In each row, one circle comes from a different painting. Circle it.

1

2

3

4

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Animal word search

Find the 6 animal words. They go across or down.

C	A	T	M	M	Y	Y	J
Y	K	Y	J	K	Y	J	O
J	H	T	D	O	G	K	W
B	M	A	R	J	Y	U	L
E	A	M	J	H	P	M	S
E	F	O	X	R	I	J	M
N	K	S	T	U	G	R	Y
N	R	Y	N	Y	H	N	U

CAT · DOG · FOX · OWL · PIG · BEE

Numbers backward

Listen to the numbers. Write them. Then write them backward.

1

Forward _____

Backward _____

2

Forward _____

Backward _____

3

Forward _____

Backward _____

For grown-ups: read each line once, slowly. 1: “3, 8, 1.” 2: “5, 2, 9, 4.” 3: “7, 1, 6, 3.”

Shopping list

Listen to the list only once. Circle the 5 colors.

For grown-ups: read once: red, black, green, blue, yellow

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Three steps

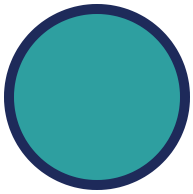
Listen to all 3 steps first. Then start!

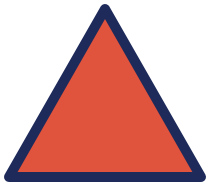
For grown-ups: read all three steps, then let your child start. Don’t repeat!
1. “Draw a circle in the middle of the box.” 2. “Draw a star above the circle.”
3. “Color the circle green.”

Secret code

Learn the code by heart. Then turn the page.

= 2

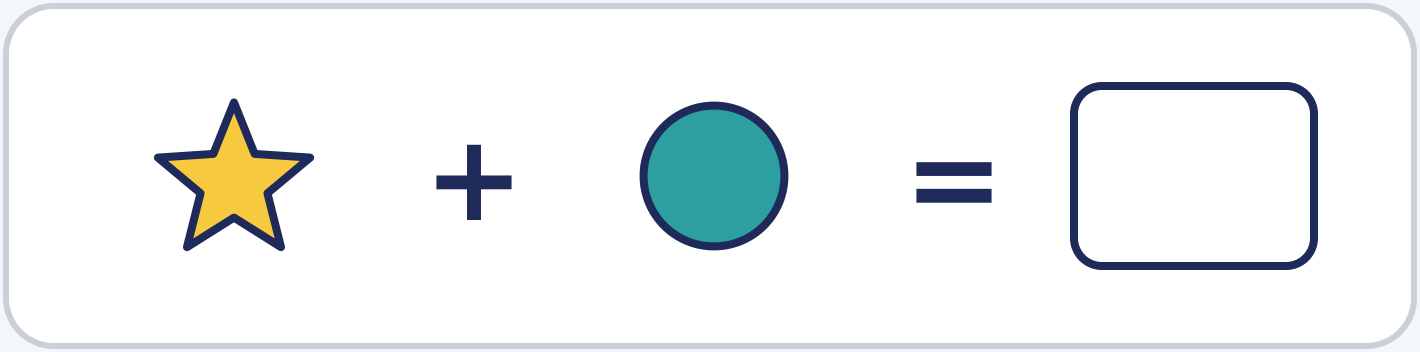
 = 5

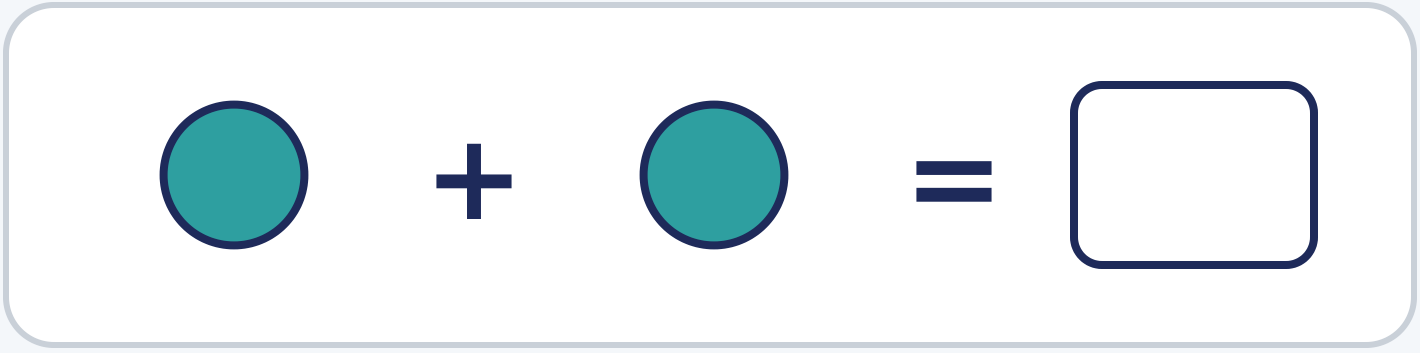
 = 7

Now turn the page!

Use the code

Use the secret code from memory.
Solve the sums.





Leon’s secret path

Put your finger on the bird. Listen to the steps. On which circle do you stop?

	A	B	C	D	E
1					
2					
3					
4					

For grown-ups: read once: 2 squares right, 1 square up, 1 square right.

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Copy the grid

Look at the top grid. Draw a dot of the same color in the same squares below.

Artwork: Robert de Farias

In Robert’s studio

Look at the picture for 30 seconds. Then turn the page.

Now turn the page!

Artwork: Robert de Farias

What do you remember?

Answer from memory. Circle the right answer.

1. How many circles were there?

2 | 3 | 4

2. Where was the bird looking?

← | →

3. What color was the top circle?

red | blue | green

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Color squares

Remember which squares have a circle, and which color. Then turn the page.

Now turn the page!

Artwork: Robert de Farias

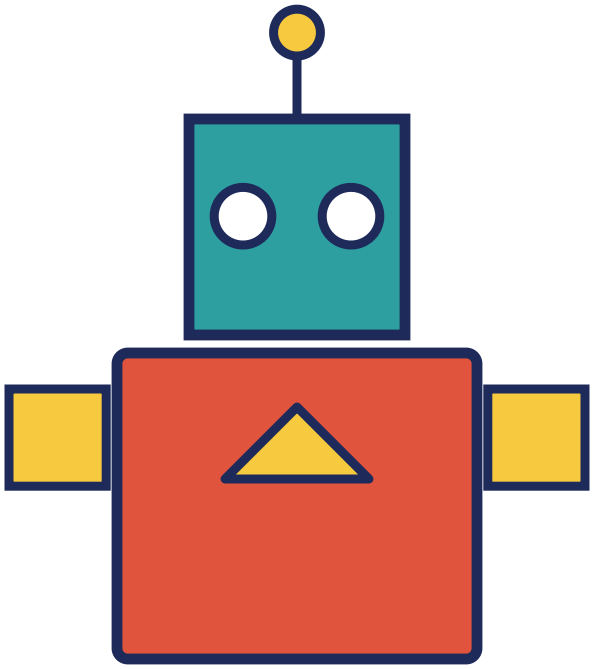
Build it again

Color the same squares with the same colors.

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Draw Leon’s robot

Look for 20 seconds. Cover the robot.
Draw it from memory in the box.



Who has which pet?

Each child has one pet. Read the clues. Put a ✓ or an ✗ in each box.

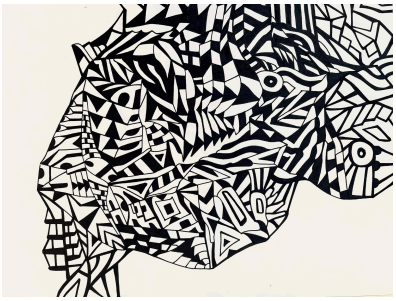
Clue 1: Ben does not have a cat or a fish.
Clue 2: Ana does not have the cat.

Ana			
Ben			
Cleo			

Who is who?

Read the clues. Write each name under the right picture.

1 _____



2 _____

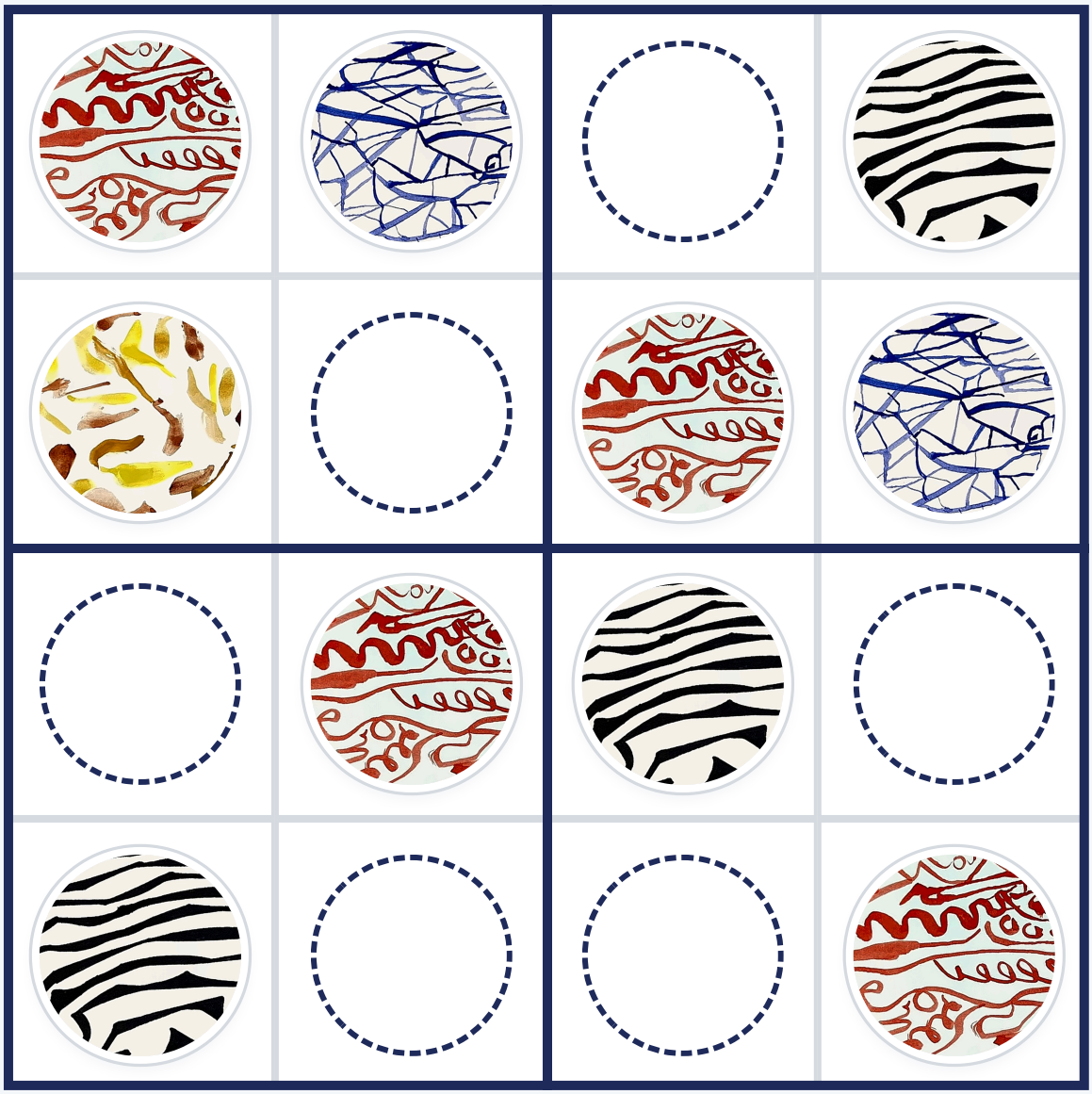
3 _____

- Mo has a green background.
- Lia is made of triangles.
- Tom is made of stripes.

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Picture sudoku

Each color once in every row, every column and every thick box. Draw a dot of the missing color.



Artwork: Robert de Farias

Picture pairs

Each circle comes from one painting. Draw a line from each circle to its painting.

1

1

2

2

3

3

Artwork: Robert de Farias

True or false?

Look at the bird. Read each sentence.
Circle T if it is true or F if it is false.

1. The bird has two black legs. T F

2. The bird is only red. T F

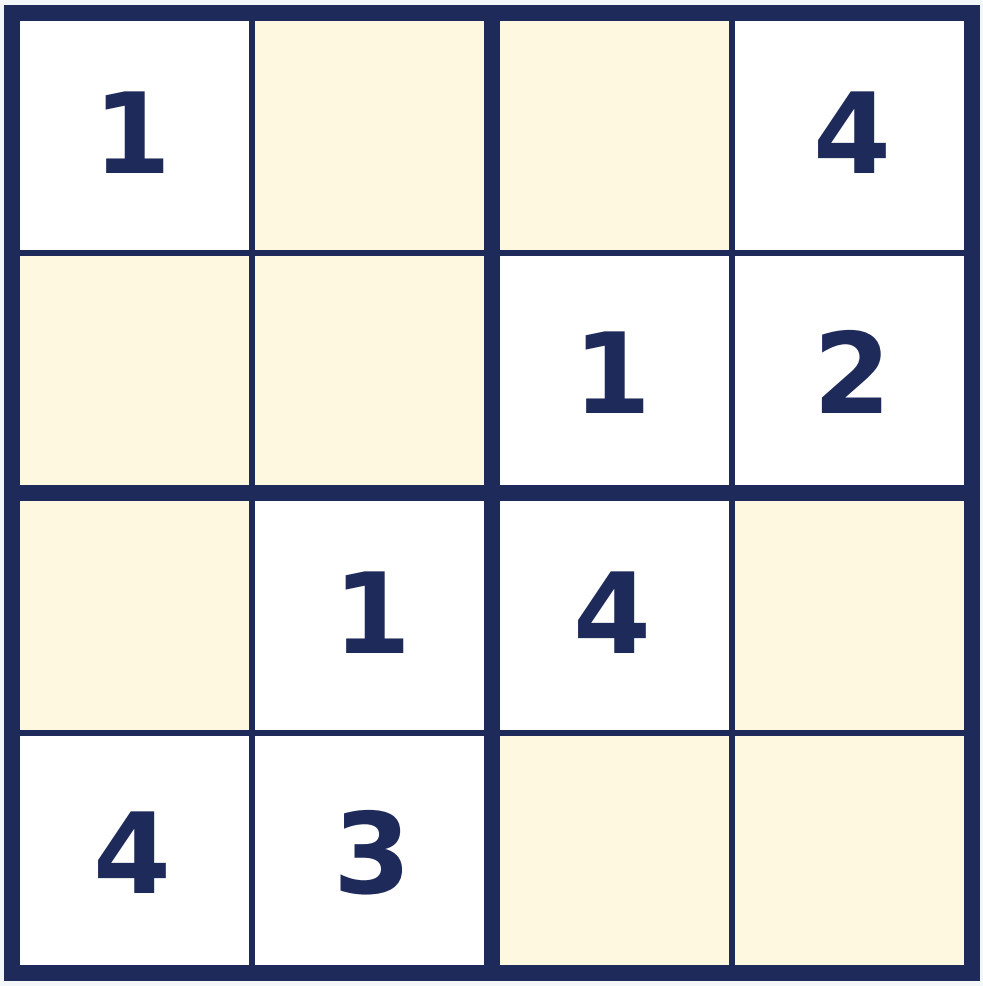
3. The bird has yellow on its body. T F

4. The bird stands on a tree. T F

Artwork: Robert de Farias

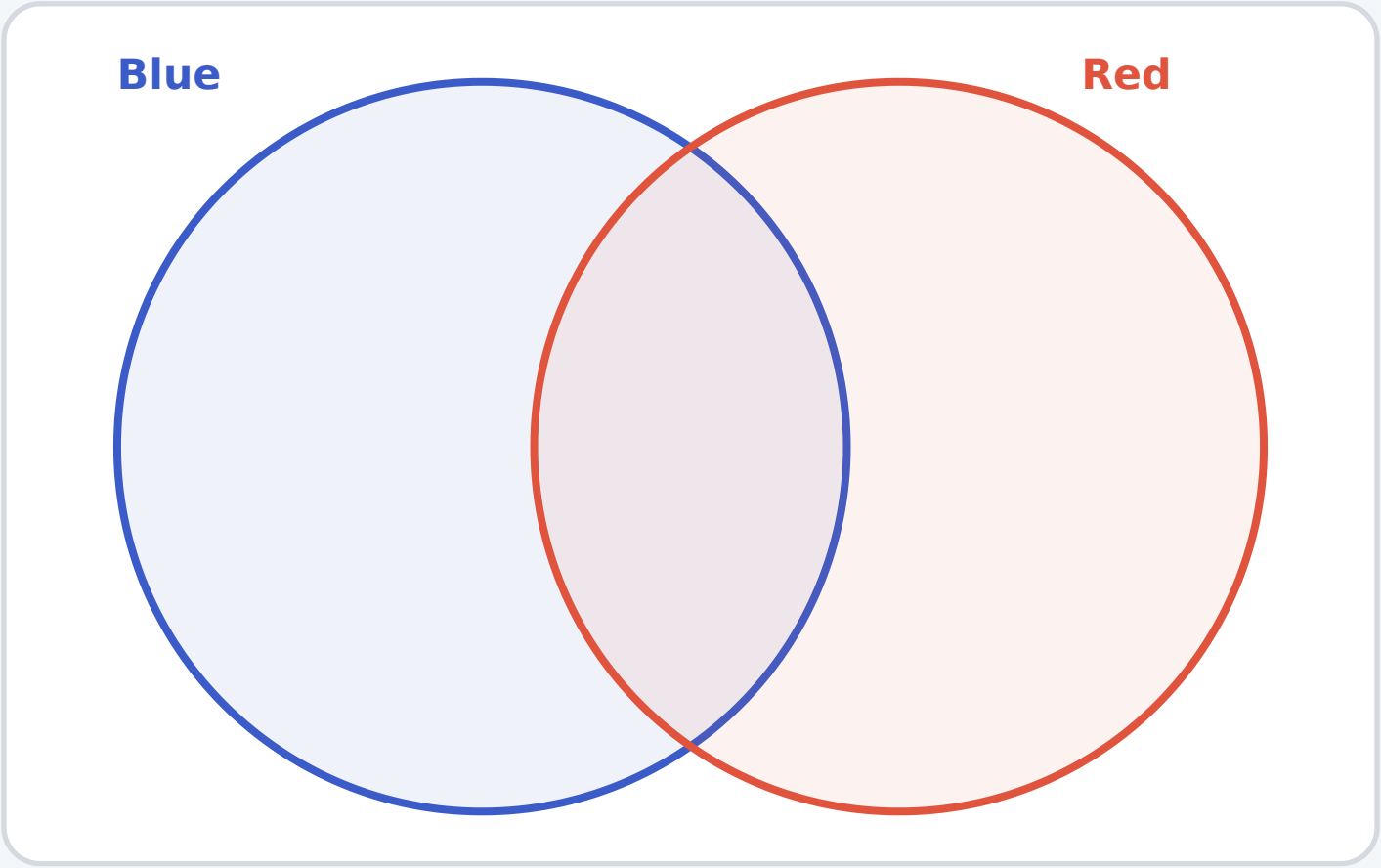
Number sudoku

Use 1, 2, 3 and 4 once in every row, every column and every thick box.



Blue, red or both?

Write each number in the right place. Some go in the middle. Some go outside!



1

2

3

4

5

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Number patterns

Find the rule. Write the next two numbers.

2	4	6		
5	10	15		
20	18	16		
1	3	5		

Growing circles

Look how the picture grows. How many circles will step 4 have? Draw them.

Step 1

Step 2

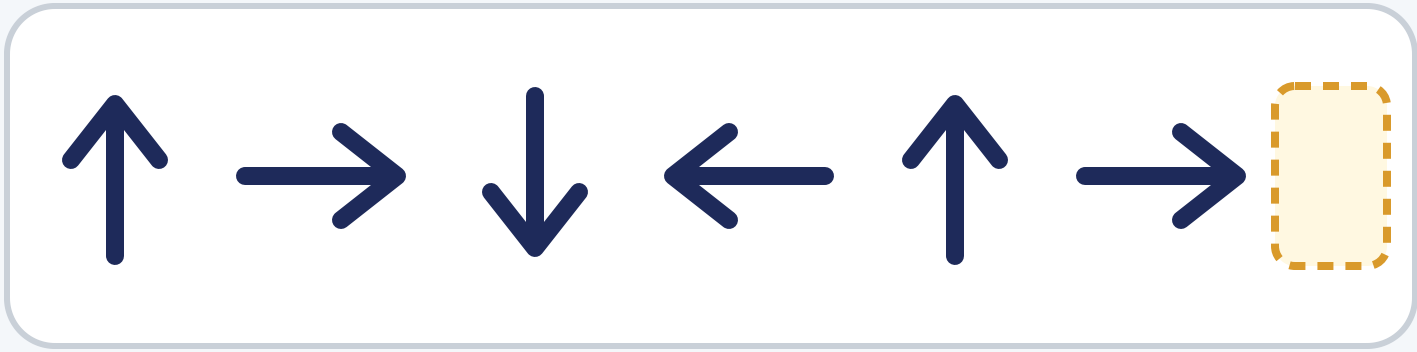
Step 3

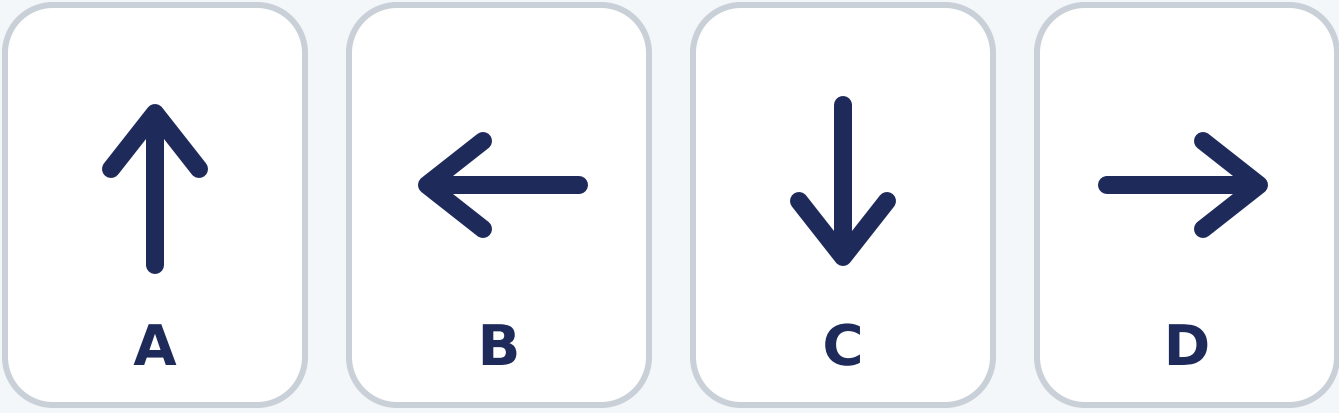
Step 4

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Turning arrow

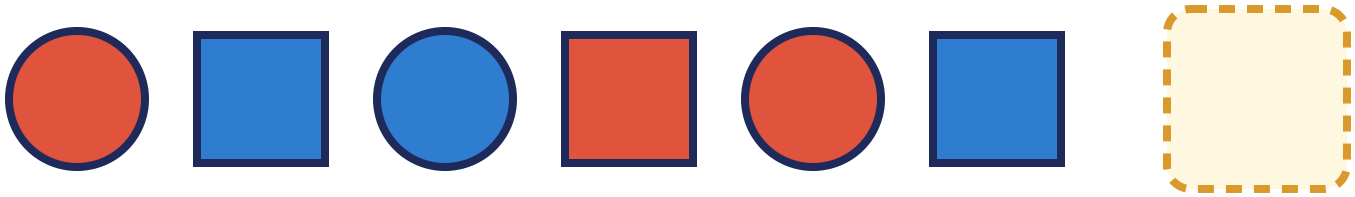
The arrow turns the same way each time. Which arrow comes next? Circle the letter.





Shape and color

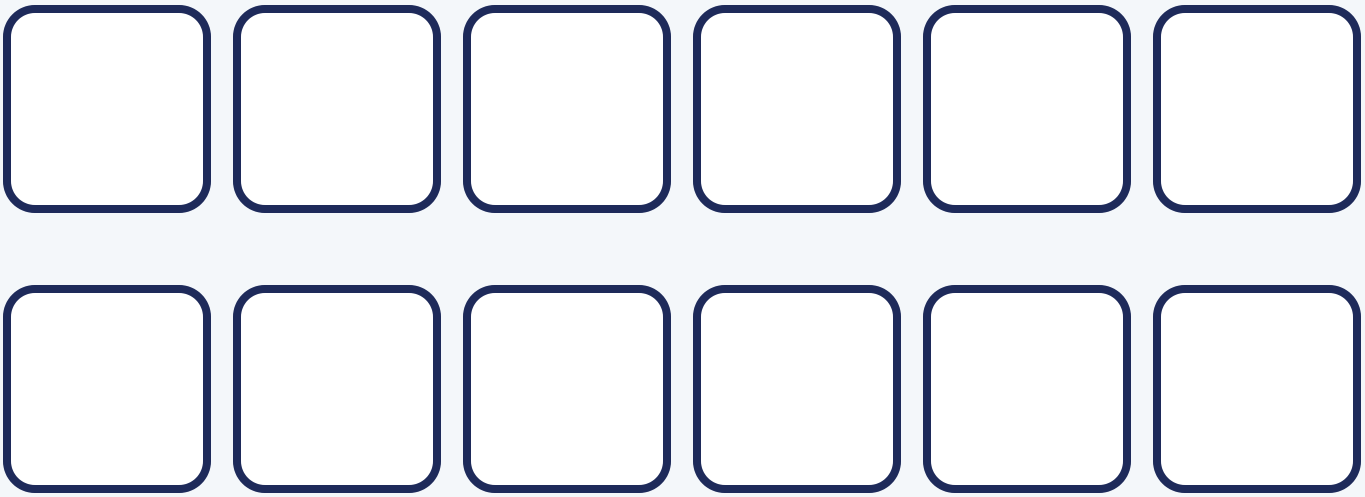
Both the shape and the color follow a pattern. Draw and color what comes next.



Now make your own pattern with two rules (shape and color) in this box!

Invent a pattern

Make a pattern in the 12 boxes. Can a grown-up guess your rule?



My rule is:

_____

My grown-up guessed:

_____

Adding to 20

Solve the sums. Count on from the bigger number!

8 + 5 = ☐	9 + 7 = ☐
6 + 6 = ☐	7 + 8 = ☐
9 + 9 = ☐	5 + 7 = ☐
4 + 9 = ☐	8 + 8 = ☐
6 + 7 = ☐	9 + 3 = ☐
7 + 7 = ☐	5 + 9 = ☐

Taking away

Solve the subtractions.

15 − 7 = ☐	13 − 4 = ☐
12 − 5 = ☐	17 − 8 = ☐
14 − 6 = ☐	11 − 3 = ☐
16 − 9 = ☐	18 − 9 = ☐
13 − 7 = ☐	12 − 8 = ☐
15 − 6 = ☐	11 − 5 = ☐

Make 10

Write the missing number so each sum makes 10.

7 + ☐ = 10	☐ + 4 = 10
2 + ☐ = 10	☐ + 5 = 10
9 + ☐ = 10	☐ + 3 = 10
6 + ☐ = 10	☐ + 8 = 10

Story problems

Read. Draw to help you think. Write the answer.

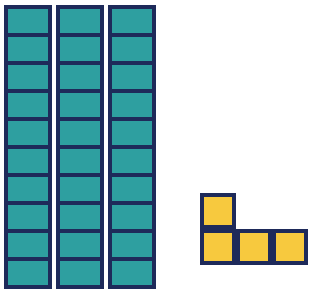
Leon has 8 marbles. Luz gives him 5 more. How many marbles does Leon have now?

There are 15 birds in a tree. 6 birds fly away. How many birds are still in the tree?

Leon has 3 bags. There are 4 apples in each bag. How many apples are there?

Tens and ones

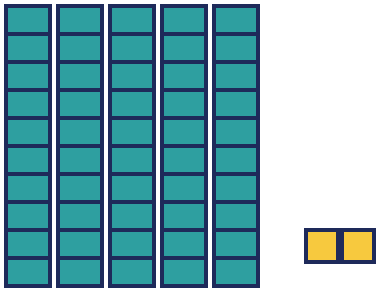
Count the tens (long bars) and the ones (small cubes). Write the number.



tens

ones

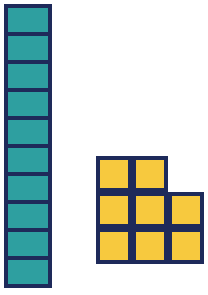
=



tens

ones

=



tens

ones

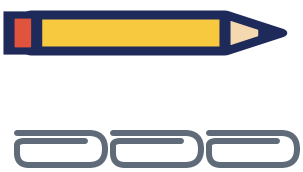
=

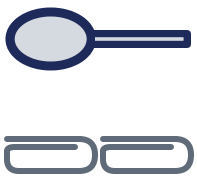
What time is it?

The short hand shows the hour. The long red hand shows the minutes. Write the time.

Paper clip ruler

How many paper clips long is each thing? Write the number.





Path of tens

Start at the top left. Move only to boxes that make 10 (up, down, left, right). Color the path to Luz.

Start

4+6	3+5	9+2	6+3
2+8	7+3	4+6	4+4
5+4	6+2	5+5	7+1
3+3	9+0	1+9	8+2
2+5	4+3	6+1	3+7

Word families

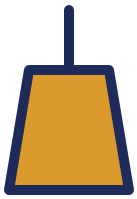
Write more words that end the same way. Say them out loud!

cat

Words that end in -at:

_____ _____

_____ _____

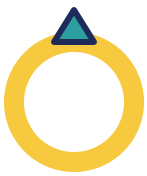


mop

Words that end in -op:

_____ _____

_____ _____



ring

Words that end in -ing:

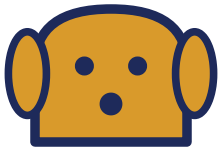
_____ _____

_____ _____

Missing letter

Say the word. Write the missing letter.

c _ t



d _ g

s _ n

c _ p

h _ t

f _ x

Word builder

Join two small words to make one new word. Draw a line.

sun	•	•	**ball**
rain	•	•	**cake**
foot	•	•	**flower**
star	•	•	**fish**
cup	•	•	**bow**

Mixed-up sentences

Put the words in the right order. Write the sentence. Don’t forget the capital letter and the dot!

cat | the | on | is | bed | the

_____

likes | Leon | apples | red

_____

sky | Luz | in | flies | the

_____

Read and draw

Read each sentence. Draw what it says.

A fish in a bowl.

Two stars and a moon.

Leon with a red hat.

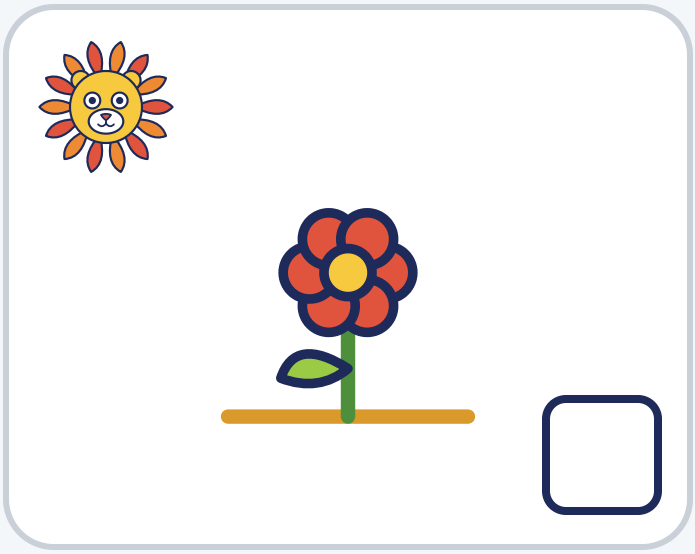
Opposites

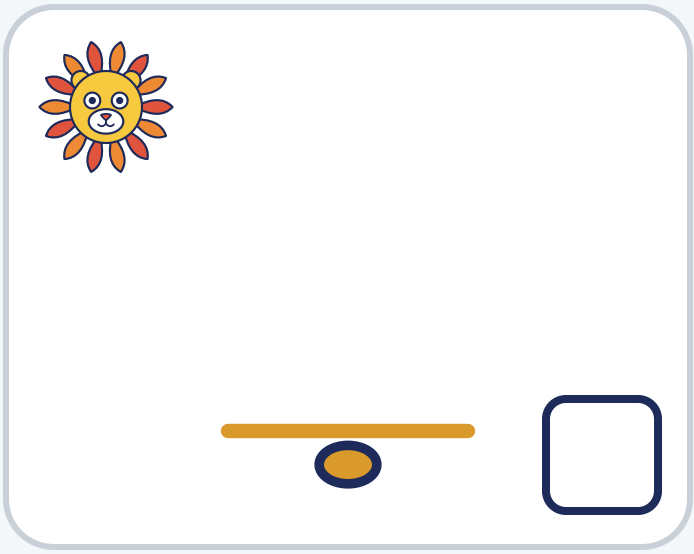
Draw a line between words that mean the opposite.

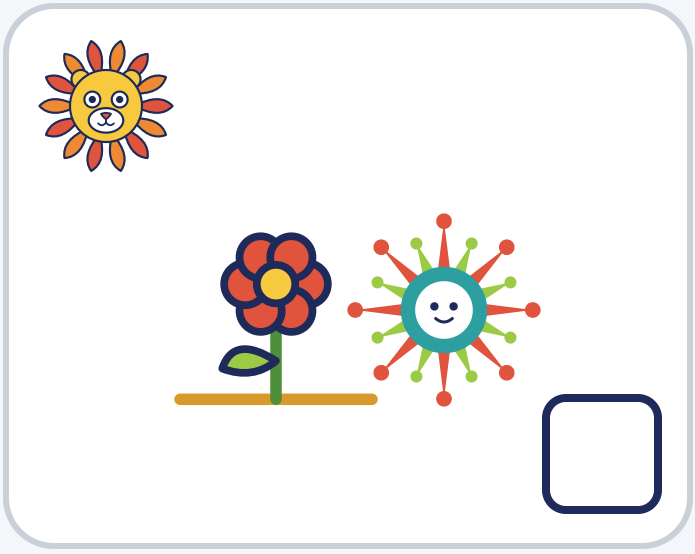
big	sad
hot	closed
up	small
happy	down
open	cold

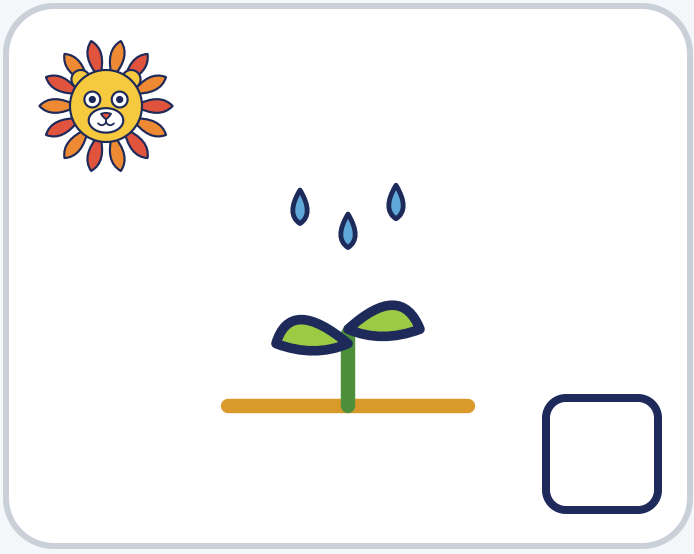
My comic story

Number the pictures 1 to 4. Then write one sentence about the story.





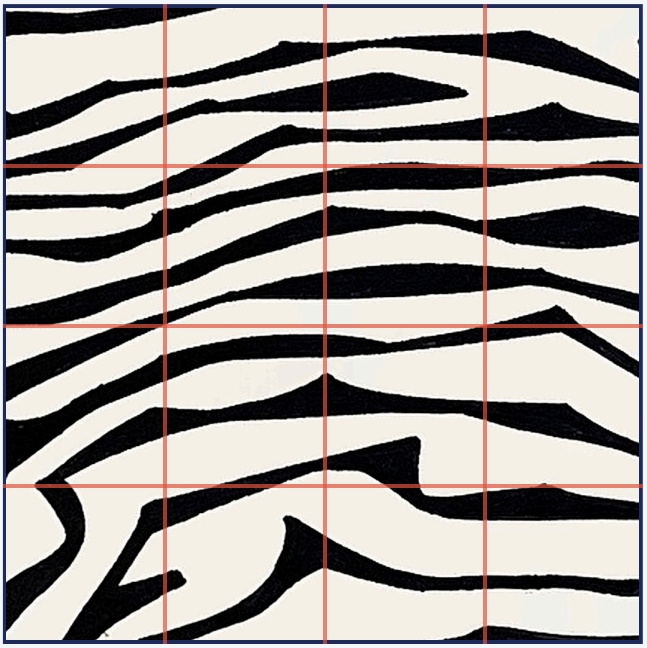


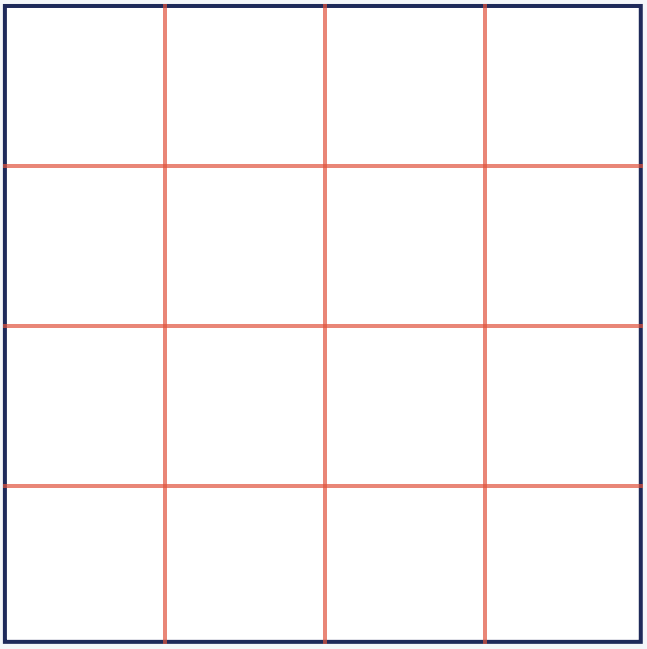


My sentence:

Grid drawing

Copy Robert’s lines square by square into the empty grid.

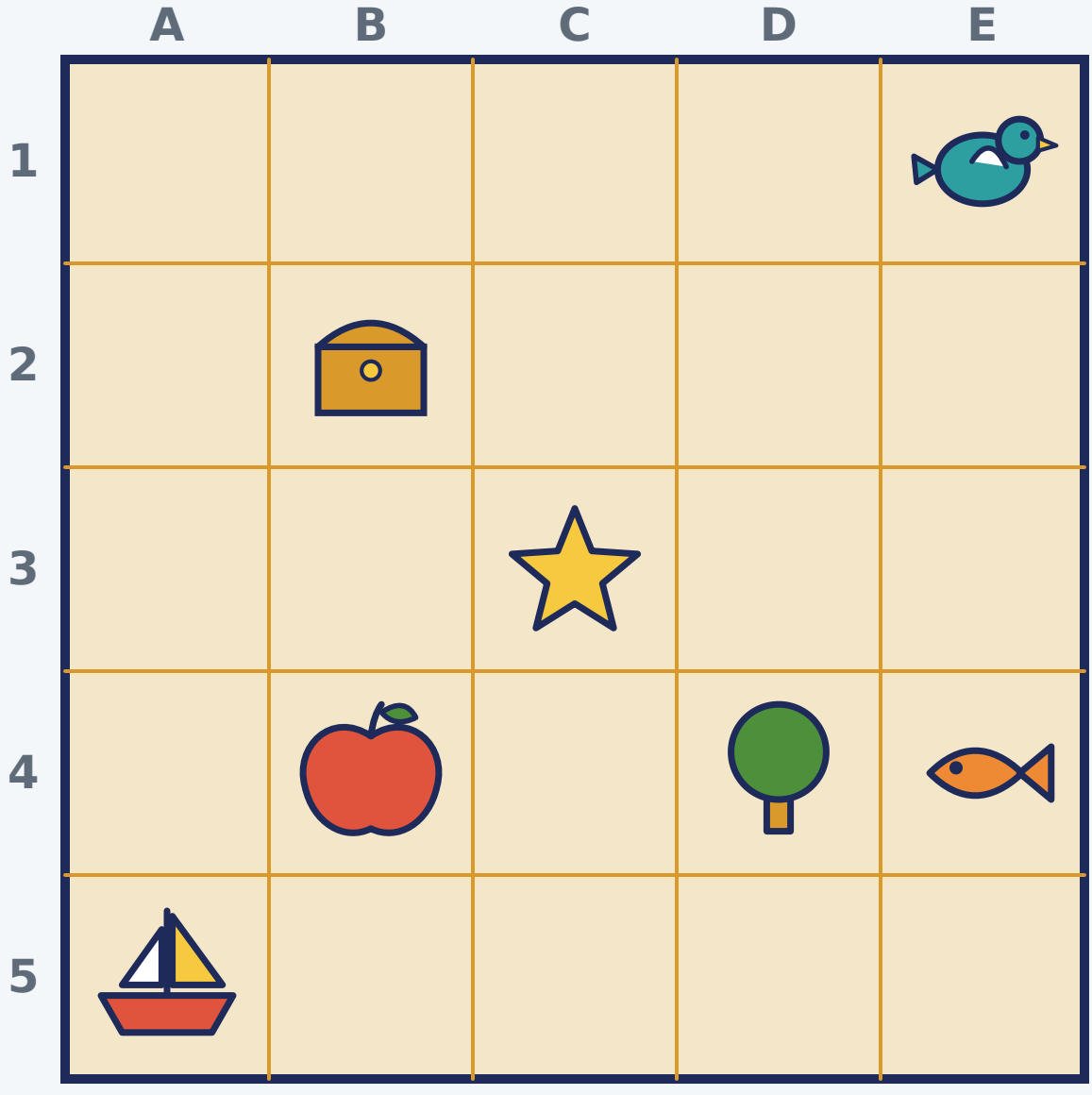




Artwork: Robert de Farias

Treasure map

Letters go across. Numbers go down.
Answer the questions.



What is at B2?

What is at D4?

What is at A5?

What is at E1?

Draw an X at C5.

Turned around

Which circle is the target, only turned? Circle it.

Target

A

B

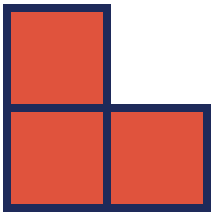
C

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Make the square

Which 2 pieces fit together to make the big square? Circle their letters.

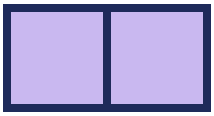
Make this square:



A

B

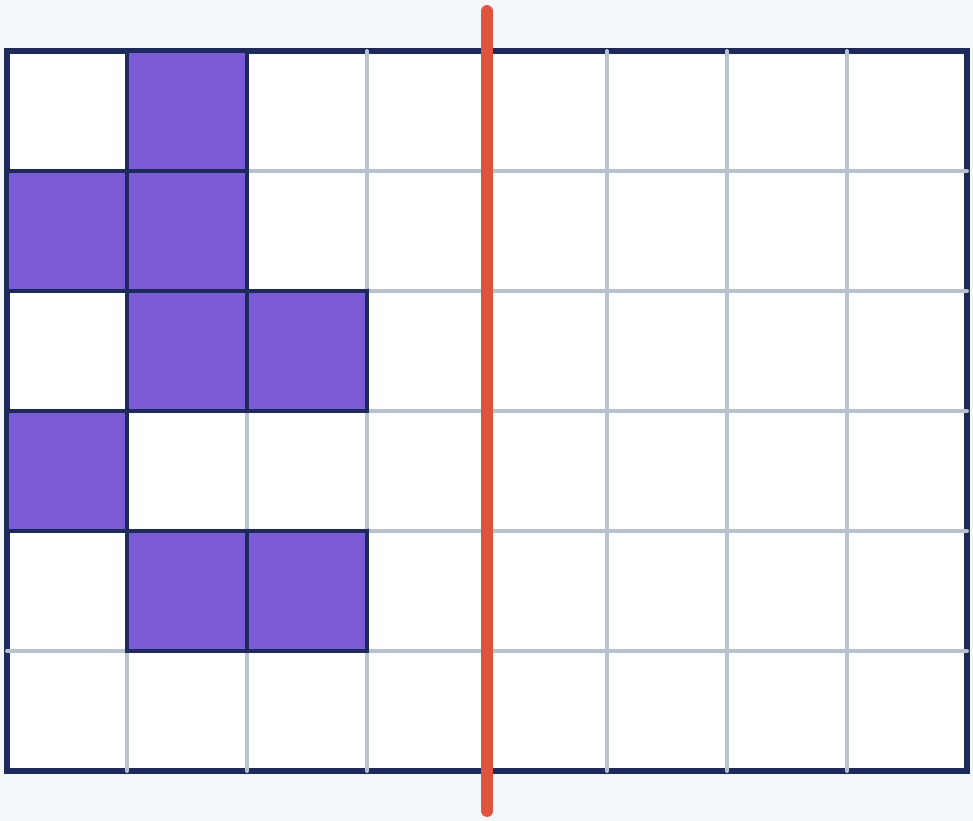
C



D

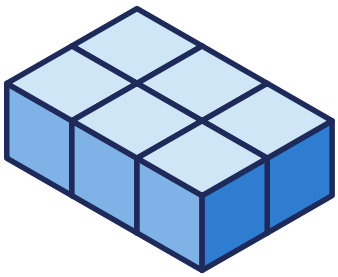
Mirror on the grid

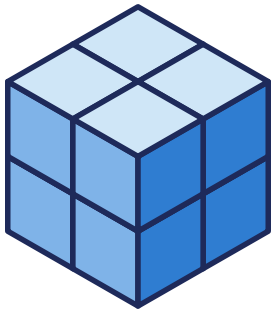
The red line is a mirror. Color the right side so it matches the left side.

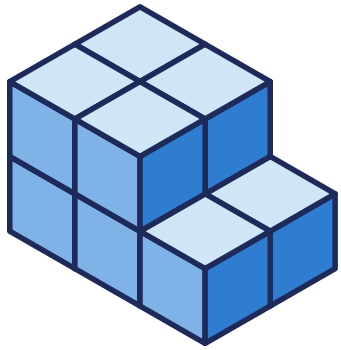


Count the cubes

How many cubes are in each tower?
Some cubes are hiding underneath!

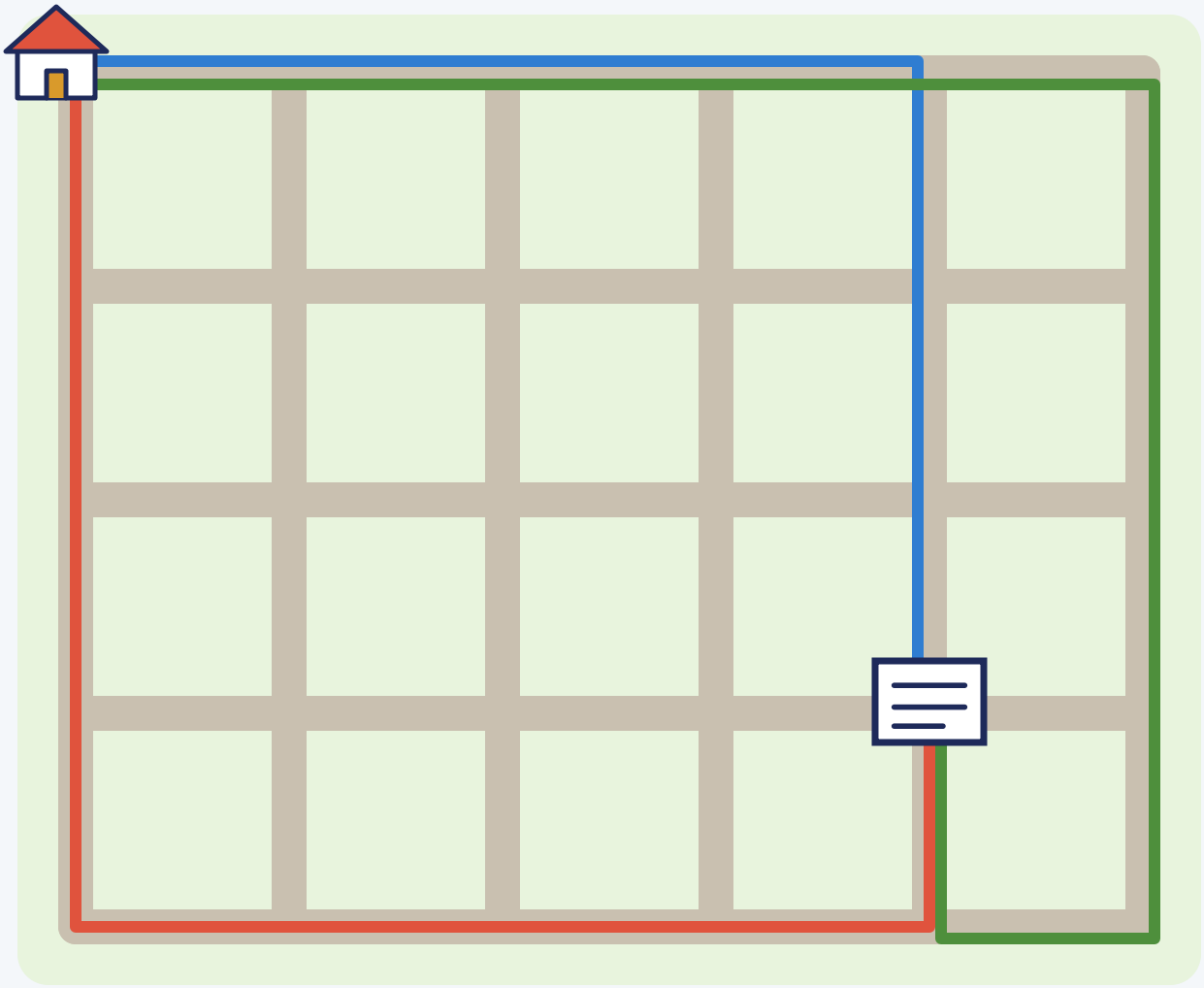






Shortest way

Leon walks from home to the library. Count the blocks on each path. Which path is the shortest?



blue

red

green

Boat trip

Take the 4 boxes across in 2 trips. The boat must be exactly full (10 kg) each time. Which boxes go together?

The boat can carry 10 kg.

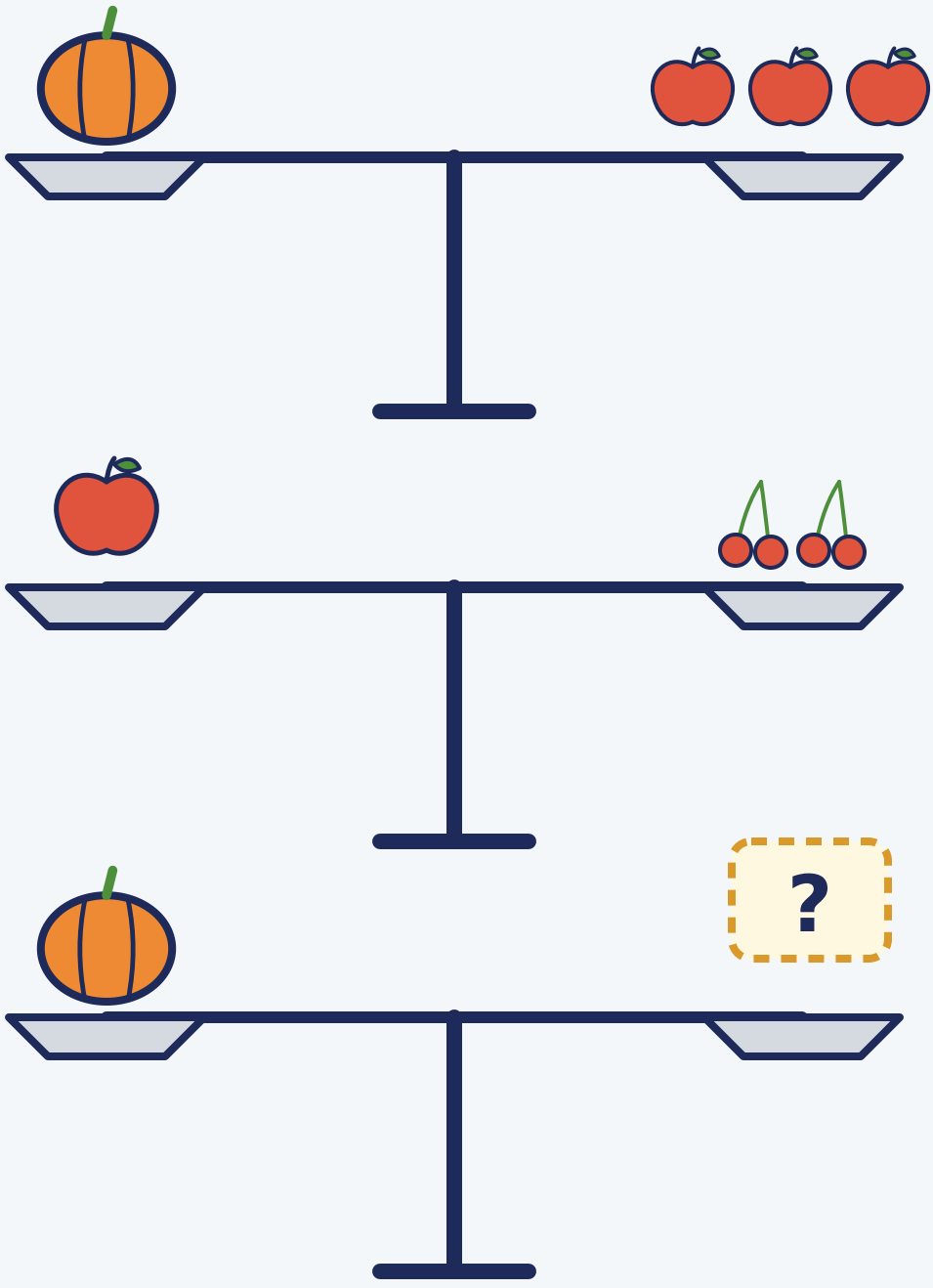
6 kg	4 kg	3 kg	7 kg

Trip 1: _____ and _____

Trip 2: _____ and _____

Balance scales

The scales are balanced. How many cherries weigh the same as one pumpkin?



1 pumpkin = _____ cherries

Fair share

Share the 12 circles fairly between Leon, Luz and you. How many does each get?

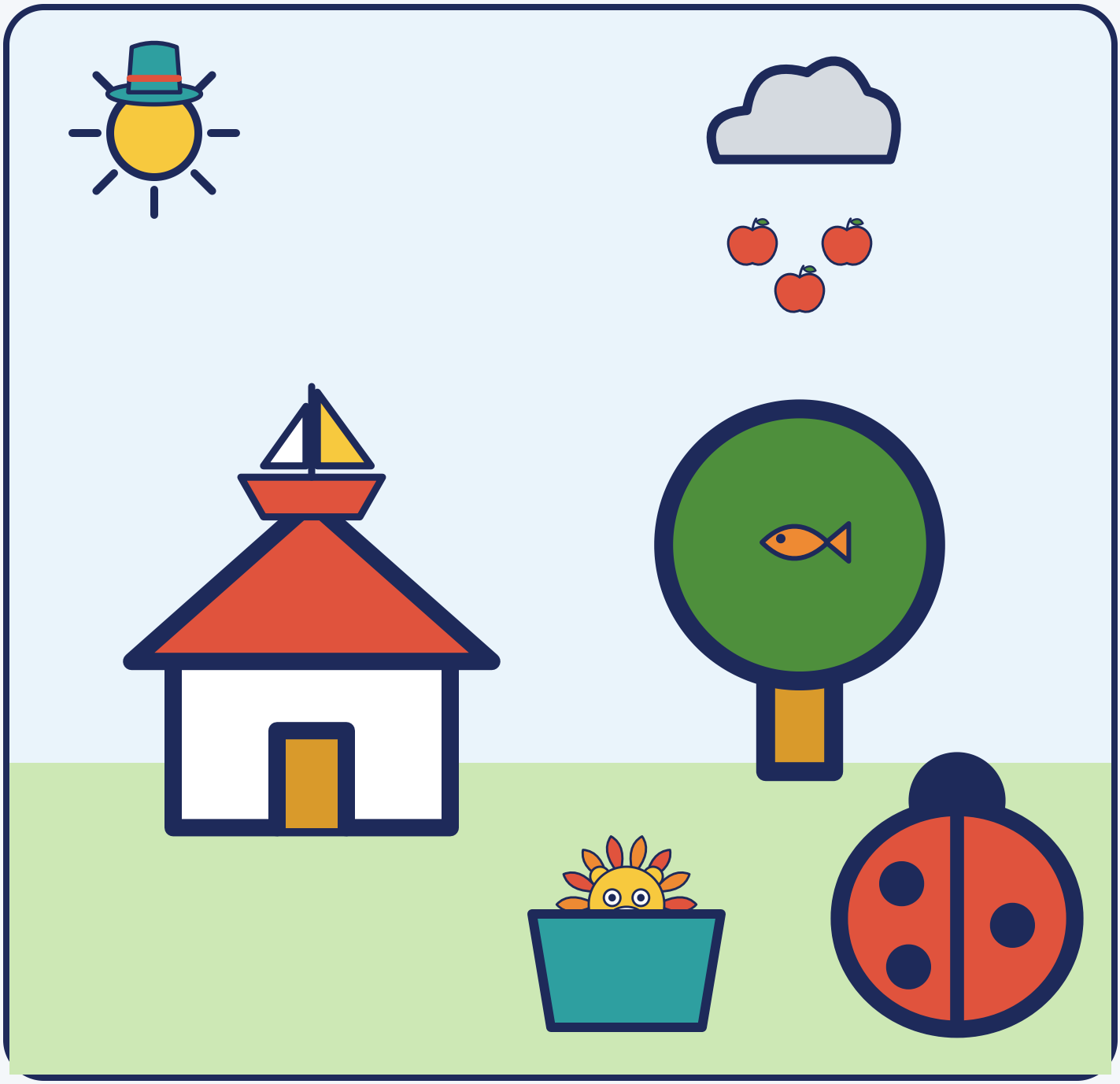
Leon **Luz** **You**

Each one gets:

Artwork: Robert de Farias

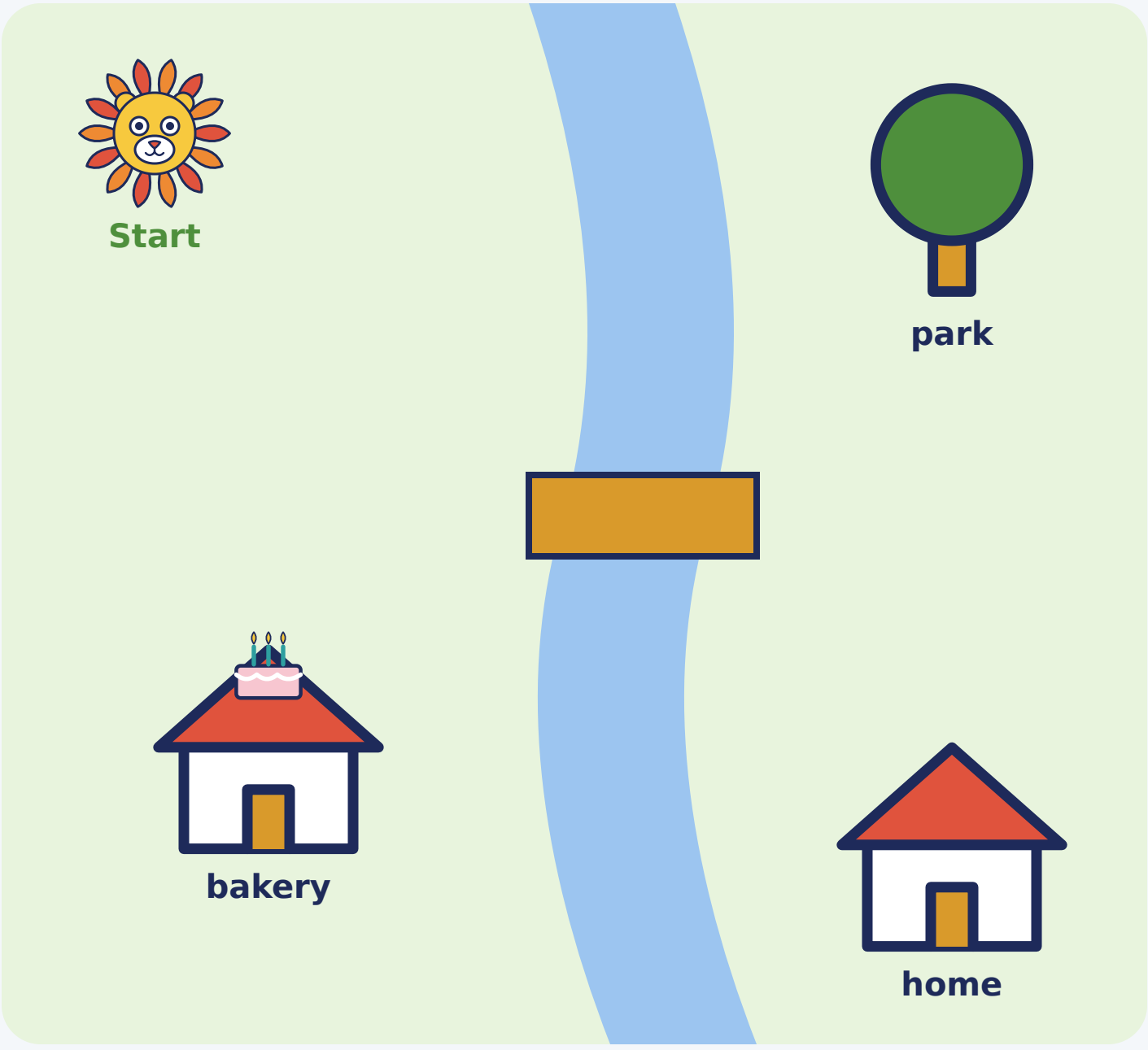
What is silly?

Find 6 silly things in the picture.
Circle them.



Leon’s errands

Go to the bakery, then the park, then home. Cross the river only once! Draw the route.



Pack for rain

Leon goes to school on a rainy day.
Circle the 4 things he needs.

Sort it twice

Write each letter in the right box of the table.

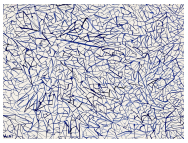
A

B

C

D

E



F

	One color	Many colors
A face		
No face		

Artwork: Robert de Farias

Say the color

Read across. Say the COLOR of the ink, not the word. It’s tricky!

RED	BLUE	GREEN
YELLOW	BLUE	RED
YELLOW	GREEN	GREEN
YELLOW	RED	BLUE

For grown-ups: try it slowly first. Then try again a little faster. Laugh at mistakes: this game is hard for grown-ups too!

My morning plan

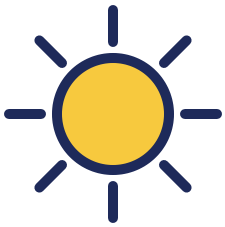
What do you do first? Number the 6 jobs from 1 to 6.

Get dressed

☐

Put on shoes

☐



Wake up

☐

Brush teeth

☐

Go to school

☐

Eat breakfast

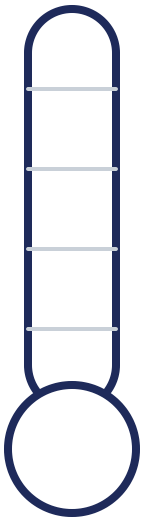
☐

How big is the feeling?

How big is each feeling? Color the thermometer. Write the feeling on the line.

Your tower falls down.

big

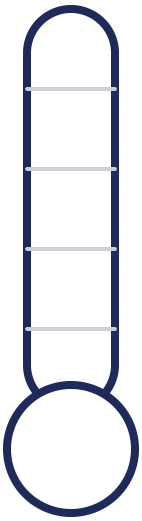


small

_____

Your best friend comes to play.

big

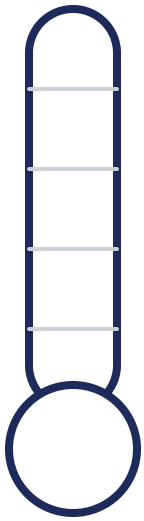


small

_____

You lose your favorite toy.

big



small

_____

What could they do?

Read each story. Color the circle next to the best idea.

Leon’s drawing got ripped.

- ◯ Throw it away and cry all day.
- ◯ Take a breath and tape it.
- ◯ Rip Luz’s drawing too.

Luz wants to play, but Leon is reading.

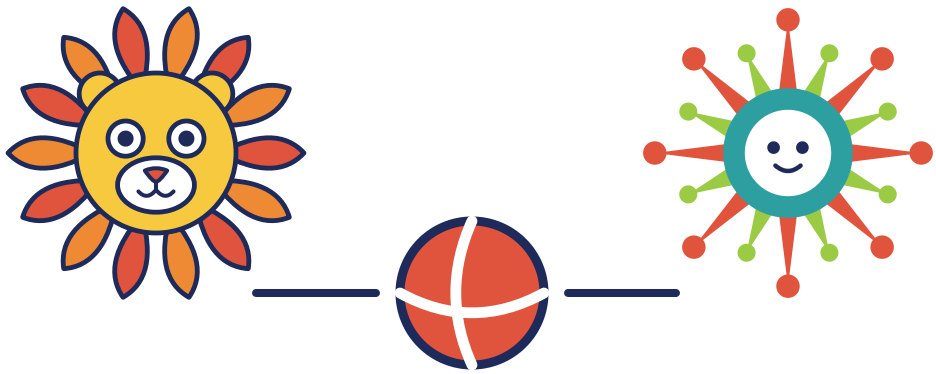
- ◯ Say: “Let’s play after my chapter.”
- ◯ Shout “Go away!”
- ◯ Hide the book.

Leon can’t do a puzzle.

- ◯ Give up forever.
- ◯ Ask for help or try another way.
- ◯ Throw the pieces.

Two points of view

Leon and Luz both want the same ball.



How does Leon feel? Why?

How does Luz feel? Why?

What could they do so they both feel OK?

My calm plan

When I feel upset, I can... Tick the ideas that help you.

- [ ] **Take 5 slow breaths.**
- [ ] **Count to 10.**
- [ ] **Hug my favorite toy.**
- [ ] **Talk to a grown-up.**
- [ ] **Draw how I feel.**
- [ ] **My idea: _____**

Mission: part 1

Solve each puzzle. The answer gives you a secret letter. Write it on page 75!

1 What comes next?

= S = K = M

2 How many stars?

6	7	8
= A	= U	= O

Mission: part 2

Solve each puzzle to get two more secret letters.

3

$$4 + 5 = ?$$

8	9	10
= T	= P	= L

4 **Which letter is at B1?**

	A	B	C
1	K	E	T
2	L	M	R
3	A	O	N

Open the chest!

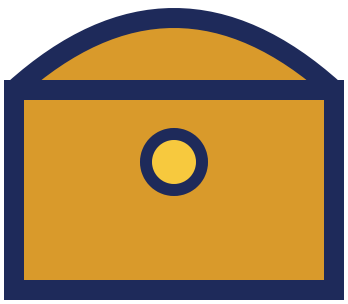
Solve the last puzzle. Then write all 5 secret letters in order to open the chest.

5

1 pumpkin = 3 apples.

2 pumpkins = ? apples

4	5	6
= D	= N	= R



1 2 3 4 5

Mission complete!

This explorer certificate is for

for finishing Volume 2!

Signed: Leon & Luz

Answers for grown-ups

p. 8	**Detail detective**	C (it comes from another painting).
p. 9	**7 differences**	Bottom: a blue awning stripe, a 4th apple, no banana, green sign, no sun, no bird, an extra cloud.
p. 10	**Number trail**	One line through the numbers 1 to 15 in order.
p. 11	**Only blue circles**	7 blue circles.
p. 12	**Odd one out PRO**	Row 1: 4th. Row 2: 2nd. Row 3: 5th. Row 4: 1st.
p. 13	**Animal word search**	Across: CAT (row 1), DOG (row 3), FOX (row 6). Down: BEE (column 1), PIG (column 6), OWL (column 8).
p. 14	**Numbers backward**	Backward: 1 8 3, then 4 9 2 5, then 3 6 1 7.
p. 15	**Shopping list**	Red, black, green, blue, yellow (not the brown circle, not the bird).
p. 16	**Three steps**	A green circle in the middle with a star above it.
p. 18	**Use the code**	Star + circle = 7. Triangle − star = 5. Circle + circle = 10.
p. 19	**Leon’s secret path**	The red circle.
p. 20	**Copy the grid**	Same squares and colors as the top grid.
p. 22	**What do you remember?**	1: 3 circles. 2: to the right →. 3: blue.
p. 24	**Build it again**	Top left red, top right blue, middle yellow, bottom left green.
p. 25	**Draw Leon’s robot**	A robot drawing with at least 4 of its 6 parts: antenna, square head, two eyes, body with a triangle, two square hands.
p. 26	**Who has which pet?**	Ana: fish. Ben: dog. Cleo: cat. (Ben must have the dog, Ana can only have the fish, so Cleo has the cat.)
p. 27	**Who is who?**	1 Tom, 2 Lia, 3 Mo.
p. 28	**Picture sudoku**	Row 1: yellow (3rd). Row 2: black (2nd). Row 3: blue (1st), yellow (4th). Row 4: yellow (2nd), blue (3rd).
p. 29	**Picture pairs**	Circle 1 → painting 2. Circle 2 → painting 3. Circle 3 → painting 1.
p. 30	**True or false?**	1 T, 2 F, 3 T, 4 F.
p. 31	**Number sudoku**	1 2 3 4 / 3 4 1 2 / 2 1 4 3 / 4 3 2 1.
p. 32	**Blue, red or both?**	Blue: 1. Red: 2. Middle: 3. Outside: 4 and 5.
p. 33	**Number patterns**	8, 10 (+2). 20, 25 (+5). 14, 12 (−2). 7, 9 (+2).
p. 34	**Growing circles**	7 circles (2 more each step).

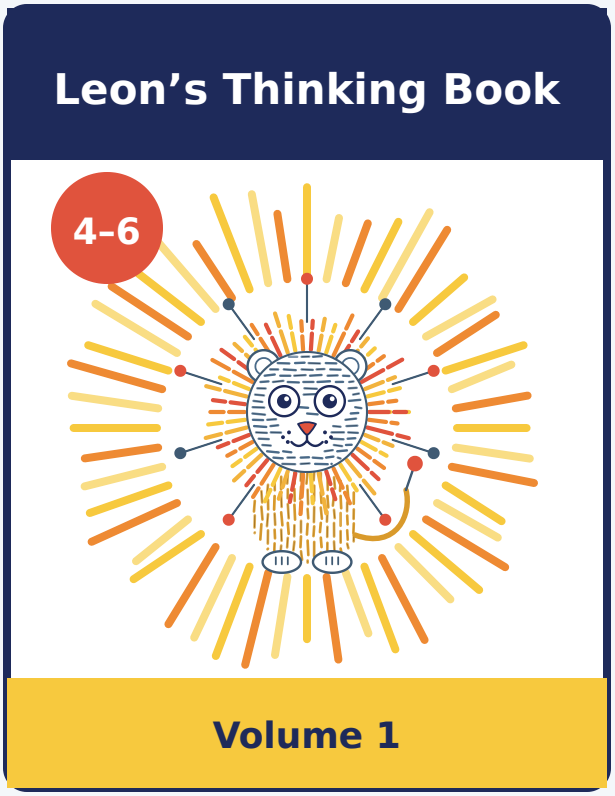
Answers for grown-ups (continued)

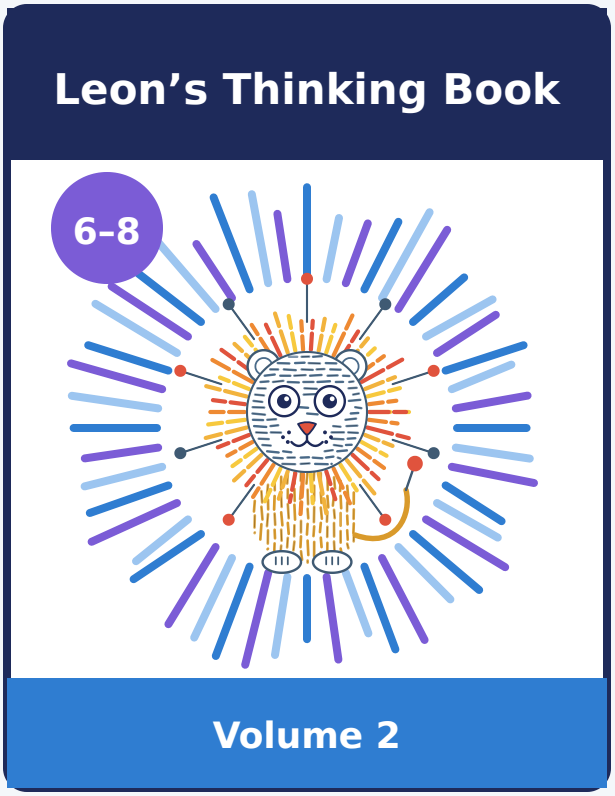
p. 35	**Turning arrow**	C (pointing down). The arrow turns a quarter turn to the right each time.
p. 36	**Shape and color**	A blue circle (red circle, blue square, blue circle, red square, then it repeats).
p. 38	**Adding to 20**	13, 16, 12, 15, 18, 12, 13, 16, 13, 12, 14, 14.
p. 39	**Taking away**	8, 9, 7, 9, 8, 8, 7, 9, 6, 4, 9, 6.
p. 40	**Make 10**	3, 6, 8, 5, 1, 7, 4, 2.
p. 41	**Story problems**	13 marbles. 9 birds. 12 apples.
p. 42	**Tens and ones**	3 tens 4 ones = 34. 5 tens 2 ones = 52. 1 ten 8 ones = 18.
p. 43	**What time is it?**	3 o’clock (3:00). Half past 7 (7:30). 11 o’clock (11:00). Half past 6 (6:30).
p. 44	**Paper clip ruler**	Pencil 3, key 5, spoon 2, fish 6.
p. 45	**Path of tens**	4+6 → 2+8 → 7+3 → 4+6 → 5+5 → 1+9 → 8+2 → 3+7.
p. 46	**Word families**	Examples: -at: hat, bat, mat, rat, sat. -op: hop, top, pop, stop. -ing: sing, king, wing, swing.
p. 47	**Missing letter**	cat (a), dog (o), sun (u), cup (u), hat (a), fox (o).
p. 48	**Word builder**	sunflower, rainbow, football, starfish, cupcake.
p. 49	**Mixed-up sentences**	The cat is on the bed. Leon likes red apples. Luz flies in the sky.
p. 50	**Read and draw**	Drawings that match the sentences.
p. 51	**Opposites**	big–small, hot–cold, up–down, happy–sad, open–closed.
p. 52	**My comic story**	Top left 3, top right 1, bottom left 4, bottom right 2 (plant, water, the flower grows, Leon gives it to Luz).
p. 53	**Grid drawing**	A drawing that follows the lines square by square.
p. 54	**Treasure map**	B2: the treasure chest. D4: a tree. A5: a boat. E1: a bird. X at C5 (bottom row, middle).
p. 55	**Turned around**	B.
p. 56	**Make the square**	A and B.
p. 57	**Mirror on the grid**	Each colored square is copied at the same distance on the other side of the red line.
p. 58	**Count the cubes**	6, 8, 10.
p. 59	**Shortest way**	Blue 7 blocks, red 9 blocks, green 11 blocks. Blue is the shortest.

Answers for grown-ups (continued)

p. 60	**Boat trip**	6 kg + 4 kg, and 3 kg + 7 kg.
p. 61	**Balance scales**	6 cherries (1 pumpkin = 3 apples, and each apple = 2 cherries).
p. 62	**Fair share**	4 each.
p. 63	**What is silly?**	A boat on the roof, a fish in the tree, the sun wears a hat, a cloud that rains apples, Leon sits in a cup, a ladybug as big as a tree.
p. 64	**Leon’s errands**	Start → bakery (same side) → over the bridge → park → home. Visiting the park first would mean crossing twice.
p. 65	**Pack for rain**	Umbrella, boots, raincoat, backpack.
p. 66	**Sort it twice**	A face + one color: A, B. A face + many colors: C. No face + one color: D, F. No face + many colors: E.
p. 67	**Say the color**	Ink colors, row by row: blue, yellow, red, green, red, green, blue, yellow, blue, red, yellow, green.
p. 68	**My morning plan**	Wake up 1, then get dressed / eat breakfast / brush teeth (families do these in different orders), put on shoes 5, go to school 6.
p. 69	**How big is the feeling?**	Every answer is fine. Talk about it: the same thing can feel big for one person and small for another.
p. 70	**What could they do?**	Take a breath and tape it. Say “Let’s play after my chapter.” Ask for help or try another way.
p. 71	**Two points of view**	Open answers. Ideas: take turns, play together, use a timer, find another game.
p. 73	**Mission: part 1**	1: triangle → S. 2: 7 stars → U.
p. 74	**Mission: part 2**	3: 9 → P. 4: B1 → E.
p. 75	**Open the chest!**	5: 6 apples → R. The secret word is SUPER!

The Leon’s Thinking Book series





Volume 1 (ages 4–6): look, remember, shapes, patterns, first numbers and letters, feelings.

Volume 2 (ages 6–8): codes, logic grids, sudoku, maps, story problems, planning and feelings.

By Robert de Farias.